

Rio Bravo High School: Auto Shop Mentoring

Volunteer instructor: James Davis. Saturday mornings 9:00 AM to noon during the school year. 8 students.

Lesson: Reading a Brake System

Objective: students learn to inspect, measure, and judge brake wear before a road test.

Outline

- Safety first: wheel chocks, jack stands, and never trusting a jack alone.
- Pad measurement: minimum thickness, when a rotor can be turned versus replaced.
- Listening: the difference between a wear-indicator squeal and a stuck caliper.
- Hands-on: each student pulls one front wheel and reports pad life in millimeters.
- Wrap-up: write the inspection on a mock work order, in plain language a customer can read.

Teaching Note

Patience over speed. These students learn the way a good mechanic learns: by hand, by ear, and by doing it twice.